CCDD Invitational #1 After Action Report

Date: November 7, 2026
Name: Sauce
Role: Linux Lead
Environment: Rocky Linux (E-Commerce), Ubuntu (Mail), Debian (Splunk), Ubuntu (Workstation).

After Action Report:

I had a late start due to not being aware that the flag had dropped. I began at 0807; Red-Teamers used default credentials at 0805 and planted persistence onto my machines before I could run my PW rotation script. This leaves a 5 min window from game start to rotate PW to ensure Red-Team does not PWN you.

Other major issues were workstation issues at game start such as sshpass not being downloaded initially and the GUI not having terminal open on linux, I was expecting only a terminal as well as the background was windows logo caught me off guard.

Throughout the competition, I was frequently pulled away from deeper hardening and investigating service outages and inject requirements. I did find suspicious activity and processes were identified; however, I was often unable to continue PID/user/persistence investigation due to limited manpower. I also forgot to report on the confirmed Red Teams service to gain points back by using a proper incident report.

Several improvements were identified for next invitational, particularly around Inject screenshots and forgetting to rotate the PW for root and sysadmin on workstation. Lastly, once Red-Team attacked they deleted sshpass and my tmp file holding the github repo files, as well as me running into issues with identifying correct service names to restart them once services turned red and went down. Future revisions of my playbook will include service discovery/recovery, as well as service to port reference sections for each host.